	SANAS R48 AND R80 **PROFICIENCY TESTING REQUIREMENTS FOR CALIBRATION, TESTING, MEDICAL LABORATORIES, AND BLOOD TRANSFUSION SERVICES**	Organisation's SANAS No/s.

Date/s of evaluation	
Assessor/s & Observers	
Conformity assessment Body (CAB)	**Azuresky Pty Ltd**
Area / field of operation	**Coal analysis**
CAB Representative	**Nonhlanhla Msibi**

This report covers the following:

Document Review only		Implementation on Site Visit only		Document Review and Site Visit		Other	

REQUIREMENTS & COMMENTS. ***Compliance = C, Non-compliance = NC***

SANAS R 48 applies to Calibration Laboratories
SANAS R 80 applies to Testing, Medical Laboratories and Blood Transfusion Services

REFER TO ISO/IEC 17025:2017 clause 7.7.2, ISO 15189:2022 clause 7.3.7.3 and ISO/IEC 17043:2023 FOR DETAIL AND CLARIFICATION NOTES.

NOTE 1: *For* ***CAB's comments****: The CAB must provide information on how requirements have been addressed, documented and/or implemented. Make reference to policies / procedures, incl. clause numbers and relevant records.*

NOTE 2: *For* ***Assessor's Comments****: The Assessor must provide information on the CAB's conformity with the requirements*

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CLAUSE	ISO/IEC 17025:2017 / ISO 15189:2022/ R 48 / R 80 How are the following addressed / implemented	CAB's COMMENTS AND REFERENCE TO DOCUMENTS & RECORDS	C/ NC	ASSESSOR's COMMENTS
	GENERAL REQUIREMENTS FOR PT / ILCs OTHER THAN PT			
ISO/IEC 17025 clause 7.7.2 & ISO 15189 clause 7.3.7.3 (a-f)	1. Does the CAB participate in Proficiency Testing (PT) and/or Interlaboratory (ILC) other than Proficiency Testing (PT) for all parameters on the Scope of Accreditation? Is there a representative and satisfactory participation in PT/ILC activities? *Note: CAB to provide details of the PT / ILC activity that the CAB has participated in, particularly since the application / last assessment. Issues to be addressed include: - what was covered; were the results satisfactory; who arranged the PT / ILC*	• Yes, the lab participates in a PT for all the parameters for the scope of accreditation *viz.*, ISO ash, ISO Volatile Matter, ISO Moisture, Calorific Value, ISO Total Moisture, and Sample Preparation. The participation is on a quarterly basis, starting Oct 2025. • See PT plan for the next 5 years. • PR report for October 2025. • Comments		
ISO/IEC 17025 clause 8.5 & ISO 15189 clause 8.5	2. Has the CAB considered its risks and opportunities in the planning of PT and/or ILCs other than PT? ***(TA to also liaise with the TL on this point)***	• Yes. Risk-based thinking has been integrated into the PT plan. • CAB evaluates the risk of non-participation, limited coverage, poor performance and provider availability. Since the CAB also serves as a PT provider, it participates in its own PT for the months it does not participate with the external provider. • Reviewed annually during management review meeting.		

CLAUSE	ISO/IEC 17025:2017 / ISO 15189:2022/ R 48 / R 80 How are the following addressed / implemented	CAB's COMMENTS AND REFERENCE TO DOCUMENTS & RECORDS	C/ NC	ASSESSOR's COMMENTS
R 48 & R 80 Section 4.1 & 5.3	3. Does the planning include an evaluation of the frequency and level of participation in PT and/or ILCs other than PT? Comment on the suitability of the "frequency" of participation of the CAB, based on the level of risk, and the minimum frequency of participation for each area of technical competence as set by the CAB.	• The PT frequency is determined by risk method risk, testing volume, and criticality • Mid-risk: Quick Ash (temperature dependant), sample preparation. • High risks: Calorific value, ISO ash, ISO Volatile • Lower risk tests- Inherent Moisture. • Participation frequency is quarterly.		

R 48 & R 80 Section 4.2	4. Is participation in ILCs other than PT only considered when PTs are not available, and/or appropriate? ***Note:*** *The availability and/or appropriateness of the PT is based on either one or combination of the following:* • *It is offered by PT provider, accredited to ISO/IEC 17043:2023 by SANAS or another Accreditation Body (AB) signatory of the ILAC MRA for PT providers.* • *It is offered by a PT provider, accredited to ISO/IEC 17043:2023 by an applicant AB or an AB that is not a signatory of the ILAC MRA for PT providers.* • *It is organised by or participated in accordance with the relevant requirements of ISO/IEC 17043:2023, to determine the performance of accredited CABs by comparison with results of other laboratories.*	• Yes. ILCs are only used when PTs are unavailable. Since the lab is still in its infancy stages, we have only participated in one round of PT. • There is no lack of PT providers. Thus, this section is not of much concern for the CAB.		
R 48 & R 80 Section 4.3 *ISO 15189: 7.3.7.3 (g-i)* *R 48 & R 80 Section ~~4.3~~ & 9*	5. Based on the outcome of the PT and/or ILC other than PT, are opportunities for improvement and any necessary corrective steps carried out? 6. Does the CAB review and monitor its own performance, evaluate possible trends and investigate all results that fail to meet the minimum acceptance criteria, including where there is evidence of consistent poor performance? 7. Is the investigation based on appropriate root cause analysis to prevent recurrence? **(TA to also liaise with the TL on this point)**	• Yes, the CAB has in place a Proficiency Testing Performance Review which monitors how the lab is doing. • Yes it does. • The document highlighted above has a section which deals specifically with Corrective actions against deviations from the acceptance criteria which follows the non-conforming work procedure		

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	8. If applicable, has persistent poor PT/ILC performance had any significant risk to the validity of results and its overall performance within its scope of accreditation? 9. Where required, has the CAB implemented and documented prompt and appropriate corrective actions to address the identified root causes of poor performance.	• The CAB is relatively new, however, it has in place steps to monitor its PT performance which has not had any deviations • No deviations were detected thus far.		
	REQUIREMENTS FOR THE CAB's PT PLAN			
R 48 & R 80 Section 5.4; 8.2	10. Has the CAB prepared and implemented a plan that indicates how and when PT / ILC activities are to be implemented for at least 2 accreditation cycles, i.e., for the past accreditation cycle (where possible) and for the subsequent accreditation cycle?	• The CAB has in place a PT plan which runs for one accreditation cycle. Since this is the initial assessment for accreditation and the CAB has only been in operation for 8 months. • See attached PT Plan.		

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R 48 & R 80 Section 9	11. Is there is a representative and satisfactory participation in PT/ILC activities covering the scope of accreditation? 12. Is the scope, frequency, and type of PTs or ILCs adequate and suitable for the CAB's scope of activities? 13. Does the CAB have the necessary technical competence to interpret and perform the tasks associated with the PTs/ILCs, including the required resources (e.g. reference materials, resources, etc.)	• Yes, the CAB is participating in PT activities covering its scope of accreditation. • The CAB has assessed its risk and has documented a risk based PT plan that covers the frequency of participation against its risks assessed. • The CAB's frequency aligns with the technical risk and testing throughput. Competency of technical personnel is assessed through testing of certified reference materials and theoretical assessments with authorization signed after successful participation of the said assessments. Equipment is readily available for personnel to use for each parameter within the scope of accreditation.		

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R 48 & R 80 Section 5.9; 5.11	14. Is the PT plan: • addressed in the CABs documented management system? • reviewed in response to changes in staff, methodology or instrumentation, revision and approval as described? **(TA to also liaise with the TL on this point)** • maintained and kept current?	• The PT Plan is addressed in the Quality Management System, under PT communication & participation, and reviews take place during Management Review Meetings held in January each year to ensure the system is maintained and kept current.		

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R 48 & R 80 Section 5.12	15. Does the CAB's PT plan include at least the following points: • Identification of participants, and/or potential participants for ILC • The name/s and or identification of the PT/ILC schemes • The proposed measurement artefact or instrument • The measurement parameters, including range and measurement points • How the reference or consensus value is to be established • The minimum acceptance criteria for satisfactory participation • How the uncertainty of the reference value or the uncertainty of the ILC is to be established • Responsibility for issue of the PT / ILC report, who shall be a competent PT provider, and who will act as the referee in the event there are only 2 participants and there is a disagreement in the results • Level and frequency of participation • Any alternative approaches to PT/ILC (only where PT/ILC is not available and/or appropriate) • ***Note:*** *Where any information above cannot be confirmed during the planning stage, is the exclusion justified.*	• The CAB does not participate in any ILC because it participates in PT schemes provided internally and externally. • Yes, Coal Concept & Azuresky PT Scheme • Coal sample for Total Moisture, ISO Ash, Volatile matter, Calorific Value, Inherent Moisture & Quick Ash as outlined in the PT Plan. • As outlined by the PT provider, "Where there are less than ten results reported, iterative statistics may not be carried out. The average value obtained shall be reported as the assigned value. Outliers shall be excluded from calculations." • The acceptance criteria is evaluated based on Z-scores which must lie between ±3. • PT provider has this displayed in their PT report. • The PT report comes with an assigned scheme coordinator assigned which deals with any disagreements or concerns raised in report. • Quarterly for the Coal Concept PT & monthly for the internal PT as outlined in the PT Plan. • There is sufficient & competent PT provider the CAB is participating in, rendering the need for any alternative PT's/ILC null and void.		
	ALTERNATIVE APPROACHES TO PT AND/OR ILCs OTHER THAN PT			

	16. Where the CAB has <u>not</u> participated PT and/or ILC other than PT for certain activities: (i) List the tests / PT items: (ii) What are the reasons for not participating in PT and/or ILC other than PT activities? (iii) Are the reasons valid and verifiable?	• The CAB has participated in PT for all testing activities in its scope of accreditation.		
R 48 & R 80 Section 6	17. In the absence of an available or appropriate PT and/ILC other than PT, does the CAB indicate alternative approaches in which they intend to participate? 18. Did the CAB provide written justification for the use of the alternative approaches, including small ILC. 19. What alternative approaches to PT/ILC is being used by the CAB? 20. Do the alternative approaches used by the CAB ensure the validity of the results?	• The CAB has a competent/accredited PT provider in place to provide such services, which it will not be participating in alternative small ILC's. • This addresses points 17-20.		
	REQUIREMENTS FOR THE PT PROVIDER'S PLAN AND REPORT			
R 48 & R 80 Section 7.1	21. Is the PT Provider's Plan in accordance ISO/IEC 17043:2023 requirements, clause 7.2.1.3? **(Applicable if the CAB is the PT Provider)**	• The CAB has made a comprehensive summary on plans it has for its Proficiency testing scheme, see attached ASMF 7.2.1.3 document.		

R 48 & R 80 Section (7.2)	22. If the CAB participates in small ILC (7 or less participants), does the PT Provider / PT Organiser Plan comply with the relevant requirements of ISO/IEC 17043:2023, and does it include the following: • Main contact person • If organised jointly, the persons or laboratories involved • The measurand or characteristic to be determined • Requirements (production, homogeneity, stability) for the ILC test item. • Information on the use and preparation of the ILC test item (description of the preparation, if applicable) • Timeframe of the scheme. • Information on the method(s) to be used • Description of the method for the evaluation of the comparability of the results, statistical analysis, if applicable, and the criteria used for the evaluation of performance. • Description of the reporting format for the participants and from the organiser. ***Note:*** *Where any information above cannot be confirmed during the planning stage, is the exclusion justified.*	The CAB does not participate in any small ILC at the moment given that there is enough PT provide which it is participating in.		
For Calibration Labs only (R 48 (7.3)	23. The CAB that is identified as the PT provider and providing the reference value for the PT/ILC scheme shall not participate in the PT/ILC scheme as a PT participant. However, if the reference value is established through consensus amongst the PT participants, then the CAB that is identified as the PT provider can participate in the PT/ILC scheme as a PT participant.	**N/A**		

R 48 Section 7.4 & R 80 Section and 7.3	24. Is the PT scheme / ILC report clear and comprehensive and does it include at least the following minimum information: • A unique report number, and identification of the PT or ILC activity • Identification of the participants • Measurement protocol (ISO/IEC 17043:2023, clause 7.1.2) • Identification of the measurement standard or Artefact • Measurement results • The reference value/s and how these were established • Evaluation of the measurement results • An indication of the performance of individual participant • Minimum acceptance criteria • Date of issue • Conclusion	• **See the attached master for the latest release of a PT report which serves as evidence of compliance to the listed information.** • **PT Report September B 2025**		
R 48 Section 7.5 & R 80 Section 7.4	25. For small ILC, does the ILC organiser develop a report which, in addition to the information in (24) above, also include the following: • Contact person • Persons or CABs involved in the organisation of the small ILC • Identification of the small ILC scheme • Description of the small ILC test item • Comparability of the participants results and/or participants performance • Comments and recommendations based on the outcome of the small ILC scheme.	**The CAB has not participated in any small ILC since there is enough PTs it is participating in.**		

Technical Assessor / Expert Signature		**Team Leader Signature**		**Date**	

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